

NorthBridge Analytics Inc.

Employee Handbook

Effective January 1, 2026 | Version 4.2
Human Resources Department

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1. Welcome and Company Overview

Welcome to NorthBridge Analytics Inc. (“NorthBridge,” “the Company,” “we,” or “us”). Founded in 2011 and headquartered at 480 Cascade Avenue, Suite 700, Portland, Oregon, NorthBridge provides data infrastructure and analytics consulting services to clients in the logistics, retail, and healthcare sectors. As of the effective date of this handbook, the Company employs approximately 612 people across four offices: Portland (headquarters), Austin, Toronto, and Kraków.

This handbook applies to all full-time, part-time, and temporary employees of NorthBridge Analytics Inc. It does not apply to independent contractors engaged under a separate statement of work. This document supersedes all prior versions of the NorthBridge Employee Handbook, including Version 4.1 dated June 3, 2024.

Section 1.1 — Mission Statement

NorthBridge's mission is to help mid-market organizations make faster, evidence-based operational decisions through accessible data tooling. Our stated core values are Curiosity, Candor, Craftsmanship, and Client Trust.

Section 1.2 — Equal Employment Opportunity

NorthBridge is an equal opportunity employer. The Company prohibits discrimination and harassment of any kind based on race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, veteran status, sexual orientation, gender identity, or any other status protected by applicable law. This policy applies to all terms and conditions of employment, including recruiting, hiring, placement, promotion, termination, and compensation.

2. Employment Classification

Every employee is assigned a classification that determines eligibility for overtime pay and certain benefits. Classifications are as follows:

Classification	Description	Overtime Eligible
Regular Full-Time	Scheduled 35+ hours/week, ongoing	Depends on exemption status
Regular Part-Time	Scheduled under 35 hours/week	Non-exempt only
Temporary	Fixed-term assignment, under 6 months	Non-exempt only
Intern	Structured, time-limited learning role	Non-exempt

Section 2.1 — Introductory Period. All new Regular employees serve a 90-calendar-day introductory period beginning on their first day of employment. During this period, either the employee or the Company may end the employment relationship at any time, for any lawful reason, with or without notice.

Section 2.2 — Exempt vs. Non-Exempt Status. Exempt employees are paid a fixed salary and are not eligible for overtime pay under the Fair Labor Standards Act or equivalent local law. Non-exempt employees are paid hourly and are eligible for overtime pay at 1.5 times their regular hourly rate for all hours worked beyond 40 in a single work week.

3. Code of Conduct

Section 3.1 — Professional Conduct. Employees are expected to treat colleagues, clients, and vendors with respect and courtesy. NorthBridge maintains a strict zero-tolerance policy for harassment, retaliation, bullying, or discriminatory conduct of any kind.

Section 3.2 — Conflicts of Interest. Employees must disclose any outside financial interest, board membership, or secondary employment that could reasonably conflict with NorthBridge's business interests. Disclosures must be submitted in writing to the employee's manager and to Human Resources within 10 business days of the conflict arising.

Section 3.3 — Gifts and Entertainment. Employees may not accept gifts from clients or vendors with a value exceeding \$150 USD per calendar year without prior written approval from a Vice President or above.

Section 3.4 — Anti-Bribery and Corruption. NorthBridge strictly prohibits offering, giving, soliciting, or receiving bribes, kickbacks, or improper payments of any kind, in accordance with the U.S. Foreign Corrupt Practices Act and equivalent international anti-corruption laws.

Section 3.5 — Substance-Free Workplace. Employees may not report to work or perform duties while impaired by alcohol or unauthorized drugs. Reasonable suspicion of impairment may result in mandatory testing consistent with applicable law.

Section 3.6 — Reporting Violations. Employees who witness or suspect a violation of this Code of Conduct should report it to their manager, Human Resources, or through the confidential NorthBridge Ethics Hotline at 1-800-555-0134. Reports may be made anonymously, and retaliation against a good-faith reporter is strictly prohibited.

4. Compensation and Payroll

Section 4.1 — Pay Schedule. NorthBridge pays all employees on a semi-monthly basis, on the 15th and last calendar day of each month. If a payday falls on a weekend or Company-recognized holiday, payment is issued on the preceding business day.

Section 4.2 — Overtime. Non-exempt employees who work beyond 40 hours in a work week (Sunday through Saturday) receive overtime pay at 1.5 times their base hourly rate. Overtime must be pre-approved by a direct manager whenever practicable.

Section 4.3 — Annual Performance Reviews and Merit Increases. Formal performance reviews are conducted annually each October. Merit increases, when awarded, take effect on January 1 of the following year and are determined by a combination of individual performance rating and department budget.

Section 4.4 — Referral Bonus. Employees who refer a candidate who is hired into a full-time role and remains employed for at least 90 days are eligible for a referral bonus of \$1,500 for standard roles and \$3,000 for senior engineering or data science roles.

Section 4.5 — Expense Reimbursement. Business expenses must be submitted through the Concur expense system within 30 days of being incurred, accompanied by an itemized receipt for any expense over \$25.

5. Benefits

Section 5.1 — Health Insurance. Regular full-time employees are eligible to enroll in NorthBridge group medical, dental, and vision plans beginning the first day of the month following 30 days of employment. The Company covers 80% of the employee-only premium and 60% of the premium for enrolled dependents.

Section 5.2 — Retirement Plan. NorthBridge offers a 401(k) plan through Fidelity. The Company matches 100% of employee contributions up to 4% of eligible compensation, and matching contributions vest immediately.

Section 5.3 — Life and Disability Insurance. The Company provides Basic Life and AD&D; insurance at no cost to the employee, equal to one times annual base salary (capped at \$300,000). Short-term and long-term disability coverage is also provided at no cost to Regular full-time employees.

Section 5.4 — Wellness Stipend. Employees may claim up to \$50 per month toward gym memberships, fitness classes, or wellness apps through the internal Perks Portal.

Section 5.5 — Professional Development. NorthBridge reimburses up to \$2,000 per calendar year per employee for approved conferences, certifications, or courses directly related to the employee's role.

6. Working Hours and Attendance

Section 6.1 — Standard Hours. The standard NorthBridge work week is 40 hours, typically scheduled Monday through Friday, 9:00 a.m. to 5:30 p.m. local office time, inclusive of a 30-minute unpaid lunch break.

Section 6.2 — Flexible and Remote Work. Employees in eligible roles may work remotely up to 3 days per week subject to manager approval. Fully remote arrangements require Director-level sign-off and are reviewed every 6 months.

Section 6.3 — Attendance and Punctuality. Employees are expected to notify their manager at least 1 hour before their scheduled start time in the event of an unplanned absence. Three or more unexcused absences within a rolling 90-day period may result in disciplinary action under the Company's progressive discipline policy.

7. Leave Policies

Section 7.1 — Paid Time Off (PTO). Regular full-time employees accrue PTO according to length of service, as shown below. PTO is accrued monthly and may be carried over up to a maximum of 80 hours into the following calendar year.

Years of Service	Annual PTO Accrual
0 - 2 years	15 days
3 - 5 years	20 days
6 - 9 years	23 days
10+ years	25 days

Section 7.2 — Sick Leave. In jurisdictions where PTO does not already satisfy statutory sick leave requirements, employees accrue 1 hour of paid sick leave for every 30 hours worked, up to a maximum of 48 hours per calendar year.

Section 7.3 — Parental Leave. Eligible employees who have completed 6 months of continuous service receive 16 weeks of paid parental leave following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child. Parental leave must be taken within 12 months of the qualifying event.

Section 7.4 — Bereavement Leave. Employees receive up to 5 paid days of bereavement leave for the death of an immediate family member and up to 2 paid days for the death of an extended family member.

Section 7.5 — Jury Duty. NorthBridge provides up to 10 paid business days per calendar year for employees summoned for jury duty, upon presentation of a jury summons to Human Resources.

Section 7.6 — Company Holidays. NorthBridge observes 11 paid holidays annually: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Jr. Day, Memorial Day, Juneteenth, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day, the day after Thanksgiving, Christmas Eve, Christmas Day, and New Year's Eve.

8. Health, Safety, and Security

Section 8.1 — Workplace Safety. NorthBridge is committed to providing a safe working environment in compliance with applicable occupational health and safety regulations. Employees must report any unsafe condition or workplace injury to their manager and to Facilities within 24 hours.

Section 8.2 — Workplace Violence. NorthBridge has a zero-tolerance policy toward threats, intimidation, or acts of violence in the workplace. Any such incident should be reported immediately to Building Security at extension 4911 and to Human Resources.

Section 8.3 — Visitor Access. All visitors must sign in at the front desk and be escorted by a NorthBridge employee at all times while on Company premises. Visitor badges must be visibly displayed.

Section 8.4 — Emergency Procedures. Building evacuation drills are conducted twice per year. In the event of an emergency, employees should proceed to the designated assembly point located in the parking area east of the building and await further instructions from the floor warden.

9. Information Technology and Data Security

Section 9.1 — Acceptable Use. Company-issued computing equipment, email, and network access are provided for business purposes. Limited personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with job performance or violate any other Company policy.

Section 9.2 — Password and Access Controls. All employees must use multi-factor authentication on Company systems and rotate passwords at least every 180 days. Shared accounts and shared credentials are strictly prohibited.

Section 9.3 — Data Classification. Company and client data is classified into three tiers: Public, Internal, and Restricted. Restricted data, including client personally identifiable information (PII), may not be stored on personal devices or transmitted through non-approved file sharing tools.

Section 9.4 — Incident Reporting. Any suspected security incident, including phishing attempts or lost devices, must be reported to the IT Security team at security@northbridge-analytics.example within 2 hours of discovery.

Section 9.5 — Bring Your Own Device (BYOD). Employees who wish to access Company email on a personal mobile device must enroll the device in the Company's mobile device management (MDM) platform, which enforces a remote-wipe capability for lost or stolen devices.

10. Performance Management

Section 10.1 — Goal Setting. Managers and employees jointly set quarterly goals aligned with department objectives, tracked through the internal Align platform.

Section 10.2 — Performance Ratings. Annual performance reviews result in one of five ratings: Exceptional, Exceeds Expectations, Meets Expectations, Needs Improvement, or Unsatisfactory. Ratings inform merit increases, bonus eligibility, and promotion readiness.

Section 10.3 — Performance Improvement Plans (PIP). Employees rated Needs Improvement or Unsatisfactory may be placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan lasting 30, 60, or 90 days, with clearly defined success criteria reviewed jointly by the employee's manager and Human Resources.

Section 10.4 — Progressive Discipline. Except in cases of serious misconduct warranting immediate termination, NorthBridge generally follows a progressive discipline model consisting of a verbal warning, a written warning, a final written warning, and termination.

11. Separation and Termination

Section 11.1 — At-Will Employment. Except where modified by an individual written employment agreement, employment with NorthBridge is at-will, meaning either the employee or the Company may end the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause or notice.

Section 11.2 — Voluntary Resignation. Employees are asked to provide at least 2 weeks' written notice of resignation to their manager and Human Resources to allow for an orderly transition.

Section 11.3 — Final Pay. Upon separation, final wages, including any accrued and unused PTO, are paid out on or before the next regularly scheduled payday, or sooner where required by local law.

Section 11.4 — Return of Property. Departing employees must return all Company property, including laptops, access badges, and any physical documents, no later than their last day of employment.

Section 11.5 — Exit Interview. Human Resources will offer a voluntary exit interview to all departing employees to gather feedback on their experience at NorthBridge.

12. Acknowledgment of Receipt

By signing below, I acknowledge that I have received and reviewed the NorthBridge Analytics Inc. Employee Handbook, Version 4.2, effective January 1, 2026. I understand that this handbook is a summary of Company policies and does not constitute an employment contract, and that NorthBridge may revise these policies at its discretion.

Employee Name: _____

Employee Signature: _____

Date: _____

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